

同志社大学 英語 過去問風演習

長文読解 一本番想定 (大問 1 題・30 分)

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高校3年～既卒 (同志社大学 文系志望)

英語 (長文読解・同志社本番レベル)

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Reading Comprehension (30 min, 35 pts) [配点 35 点]

Read the following passage and answer the questions.

The art of conversation, once central to civic and intellectual life, has been quietly transformed by digital technology. (A) For centuries, conversation was a sustained, face-to-face exchange in which participants developed ideas together over hours or days. Salons in eighteenth-century Paris, coffee houses in London, and the agora of ancient Athens all served as venues for the slow, patient work of dialogue.

The arrival of text messaging, social media, and group chats has not eliminated conversation, but has fundamentally altered its rhythm and depth. (B) Sherry Turkle, an MIT sociologist, has documented how young people increasingly prefer texting to talking, even with people sitting next to them. The reasons are revealing: text gives the illusion of control, allowing one to edit responses, ignore questions, and disengage at will.

Yet something is lost. Face-to-face conversation requires vulnerability. We must respond in real time to facial expressions, tone, and silences that we cannot fully predict. (C) Research suggests that empathy — the ability to understand another person's perspective — depends precisely on this kind of unscripted, embodied exchange. Studies of college students show measurable declines in empathy scores over the past two decades, coinciding with the rise of smartphone use.

None of this means we should abandon digital communication. Texting and social media have genuine virtues — connecting friends across continents, supporting marginalized communities, enabling rapid coordination. The question is one of balance: do we still make time for the slower, harder work of real conversation?

Some institutions are responding deliberately. Certain schools now enforce "phone-free" lunch hours. Companies hold meetings without devices. Families designate dinner as a screen-free zone. These small gestures recognize that conversation, like any skill, requires deliberate practice — and that something irreplaceable is at stake.

Notes:

agora — 古代ギリシャの公共広場

vulnerability — 弱さ・無防備さ

unscripted — 台本のない

Reading Comprehension (30 min, 35 pts) — Questions

Q1

1

What does underlined sentence (A) suggest about traditional conversation?

- ① It was a brief, superficial exchange.
- ② It was a sustained, face-to-face exchange developing ideas over hours or days.
- ③ It only happened through written letters.
- ④ It was unique to the modern era.

Q2

2

According to underlined sentence (B), what does Sherry Turkle observe?

- ① Young people prefer face-to-face conversation.
- ② Young people increasingly prefer texting to talking, even with people next to them.
- ③ Adults are abandoning all forms of communication.
- ④ Texting has been banned in MIT.

Q3

3

Why do people prefer texting according to the passage?

- ① It is more expensive.
- ② It gives the illusion of control — editing, ignoring, disengaging at will.
- ③ It is mandatory in schools.
- ④ It is faster than phone calls.

Q4 4

What does underlined sentence (C) claim about empathy?

- ① Empathy depends on unscripted, embodied (face-to-face) exchange.
- ② Empathy is only learned through textbooks.
- ③ Empathy has no relation to communication style.
- ④ Empathy can be perfectly developed through texting alone.

Q5 5

What does the passage NOT claim about digital communication?

- ① It connects friends across continents.
- ② It supports marginalized communities.
- ③ It enables rapid coordination.
- ④ It should be banned entirely.

Q6 6

What kind of measures are some institutions taking?

- ① Mandating constant smartphone use
- ② Phone-free lunch hours, device-free meetings, screen-free family dinners
- ③ Banning all in-person meetings
- ④ Replacing all teachers with chatbots

Q7 7

Which best summarizes the author's position?

- ① We should abandon all digital communication.
- ② Digital communication is harmless and need not be balanced.
- ③ Digital communication has virtues but real conversation requires deliberate practice and must not be lost.
- ④ Empathy is irrelevant in the modern world.

解答・解説

問	解答	解説
1	②	【正解】② 下線部 (A) 「sustained, face-to-face exchange in which participants developed ideas together over hours or days」と一致。
2	②	【正解】② 下線部 (B) 「young people increasingly prefer texting to talking, even with people sitting next to them」と一致。
3	②	【正解】② 第2段落「text gives the illusion of control, allowing one to edit responses, ignore questions, and disengage at will」と一致。
4	①	【正解】① 下線部 (C) 「empathy ... depends precisely on this kind of unscripted, embodied exchange」と一致。
5	④	【正解】④ 第4段落で digital communication の長所として ①②③ を列挙。「禁止すべき」は記述なし(むしろ「abandon すべきでない」と明言)。
6	②	【正解】② 最終段落「phone-free lunch hours」「meetings without devices」「dinner as a screen-free zone」と一致。
7	③	【正解】③ 第4段落「Texting and social media have genuine virtues」＋最終段落「conversation ... requires deliberate practice ... something

問	解答	解説
		irreplaceable is at stake」 とバランス論で一致。